

Article | 22 June 2026

COMMODITIES DAILY

The Commodities Feed: Oil rises amid shaky start to US-Iran ceasefire

Oil prices are higher this morning as tensions between the US and Iran remain elevated despite a temporary ceasefire



Energy - Speculators build the short in ICE Brent

Oil prices have moved higher this morning as the US-Iran ceasefire gets off to a rocky start. Talks initially scheduled for Friday were delayed until Sunday. And Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) said it closed the Strait of Hormuz over the weekend due to Israeli attacks on Lebanon. The effectiveness of this announced closure is another question. The US Central Command says that 17 million barrels had passed the Strait of Hormuz on Saturday. Meanwhile, President Trump threatened further strikes on Iran if Hezbollah in Lebanon continues attacking Israel.

Recent developments show that moving towards a more permanent deal will be challenging, with very real risks of a flare-up in hostilities during the 60-day ceasefire. For energy markets, the key factor is still whether oil and LNG flows from the Persian Gulf continue to recover, despite all the rhetoric.

The latest positioning data show that speculators significantly reduced their net long in ICE Brent over the last reporting week, amid the temporary ceasefire between the US and Iran. Speculators sold 94,763 lots, leaving them with a net long of 114,128 lots, the smallest net long since December 2025. Interestingly, the move was dominated by fresh shorts entering the market. They bought 74,581 lots, leaving the gross short at 231,218 lots, the largest since

December. Clearly, if US-Iran talks don't progress well, there's a very real risk that these shorts will have to run in and cover.

In natural gas markets, ongoing tension between the US and Iran has seen TTF prices rally by more than 3% this morning. As we move deeper into the injection season and closer to the 2026/27 winter, the European gas market will become increasingly sensitive to developments in the Middle East. Particularly given that EU gas storage remains well below normal levels for this stage of the year. Gas storage stands at just over 46% full, vs a 5-year average of 61% full.

Metals – Gold extends losses

Gold fell for a third consecutive session on Friday, posting a third straight weekly decline. The metal lost more than 2% over the week as investors weighed the outlook for US-Iran negotiations and US monetary policy. While geopolitical tensions in the Middle East remain elevated, the resumption of oil and LNG flows through the Strait of Hormuz has eased concerns over energy supply disruptions and reduced fears of a broader inflation shock. At the same time, hawkish comments from Federal Reserve Chair Kevin Warsh reinforced expectations that US interest rates will remain higher for longer. This reduces the appeal of non-yielding assets such as gold.

Gold is likely to remain sensitive to developments in the Middle East and shifts in Fed rate expectations. While geopolitical risks should continue to provide underlying support, a higher-for-longer US rate environment may limit near-term upside.

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